



IDS11072

Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia

Issued at 3:40 am CST on Tuesday 18 August 2026
for the period until midnight CST Thursday 20 August 2026.

Please be aware

Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A large blocking high pressure system persists over the Tasman Sea. An upper level disturbance responsible for precipitation over central and eastern parts will weaken today as a weakening cold front moves across western parts today and across the southeast on Wednesday. A high pressure ridge is expected to develop over South Australia from Wednesday afternoon with weak troughs clipping the southeast in a broad westerly flow on Thursday and Friday.

Far West Coast: WA-SA Border to Fowlers Bay

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots shifting westerly in the late morning. Winds reaching up to 25 knots offshore in the late afternoon. Seas: 1 to 2 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Winds: Westerly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots offshore early in the morning. Winds becoming variable about 10 knots in the morning. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Becoming cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: North to northeasterly about 10 knots becoming east to southeasterly during the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Upper West Coast: Fowlers Bay to Elliston

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots shifting westerly in the early afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Winds: Westerly 15 to 20 knots decreasing to about 10 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: Variable below 10 knots. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 3 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Lower West Coast: Elliston to Cape Carnot

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots turning west to northwesterly in the late afternoon. Winds reaching up to 25 knots offshore in the late evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres around midday. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Becoming cloudy. 90% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm inshore this evening.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Winds: Westerly 15 to 25 knots decreasing to about 10 knots in the late evening. Seas: 1.5 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning, then decreasing to 1 metre by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: West to southwesterly about 10 knots becoming northwesterly during the morning then becoming west to southwesterly during the afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 3 metres inshore, increasing to 2.5 to 4 metres offshore. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Central Coast

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots turning northwesterly 20 to 25 knots in the evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Becoming cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm this evening.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Winds: Northwesterly 20 to 25 knots turning westerly 15 to 25 knots early in the morning. Seas: 1.5 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 to 1.5 metres by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres, tending westerly 2.5 to 3 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy. 70% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the early morning.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: Westerly 10 to 15 knots decreasing to about 10 knots during the afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 2 to 3 metres, increasing to 2.5 to 4 metres in the west. Weather: Partly cloudy.

South Central Coast

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Strong Wind Warning for Tuesday for South Central Coast

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 25 knots, reaching up to 30 knots west of Kangaroo Island in the late evening. Winds tending north to northwesterly 20 to 25 knots in the late evening. Seas: 1 to 2 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm this evening.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Strong Wind Warning for Wednesday for South Central Coast

Winds: Northwesterly 20 to 25 knots, reaching up to 30 knots during the day. Winds turning westerly 15 to 25 knots during the morning. Seas: 1.5 to 2.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres, tending westerly 2.5 to 3 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy. 90% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the early morning.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: Westerly 15 to 20 knots decreasing to about 10 knots during the evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre during the evening. Swell: Westerly 3 metres, increasing to 2.5 to 4 metres during the morning. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Upper South East Coast: Murray Mouth to Cape Jaffa

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots, reaching up to 25 knots offshore in the late morning. Seas: 1 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the afternoon. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 90% chance of showers.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Strong Wind Warning for Wednesday for Upper South East Coast

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots turning west to northwesterly during the morning. Winds reaching up to 30 knots south of Salt Creek in the late morning and early afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2.5 metres south of Salt Creek. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres, tending westerly 2 to 2.5 metres by early evening. Weather: Partly cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm offshore in the early morning.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: Westerly 15 to 20 knots decreasing to about 10 knots during the evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the morning. Swell: Westerly 2 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers.

Lower South East Coast: Cape Jaffa to SA-VIC Border

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots, reaching up to 25 knots offshore in the late morning and early afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres around midday. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 90% chance of showers.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Strong Wind Warning for Wednesday for Lower South East Coast

Winds: North to northeasterly 20 to 25 knots turning west to northwesterly during the morning. Winds reaching up to 30 knots during the day. Seas: 1.5 to 2.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, tending westerly 2 to 3 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Cloudy. Near 100% chance of showers.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: Westerly 15 to 25 knots decreasing to 10 to 15 knots during the afternoon. Seas: 1 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the evening. Swell: Westerly 2.5 to 3 metres, increasing to 3 to 4 metres south of Port MacDonnell. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots tending north to northwesterly in the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo around midday. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Port Neill to Port Victoria. Weather: Becoming cloudy. 90% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm south of Port Neill to Port Victoria this evening.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Winds: Northwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning westerly 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the afternoon. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Port Neill to Port Victoria. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm north of Cowell to Wallaroo in the early morning.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northerly 15 to 20 knots during the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Winds: North to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning westerly 10 to 15 knots in the afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre by early evening. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy. 90% chance of showers.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: Variable below 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre.
Weather: Partly cloudy.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northerly 15 to 20 knots in the late morning and afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to around 1 metre during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm this evening.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Winds: North to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots tending west to northwesterly 15 to 25 knots early in the morning. Seas: 1 to 2 metres. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning, then increasing to 1 to 2 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the early morning.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: Westerly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Westerly 1.5 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 9:30 am CST Tuesday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.
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